

2.4 Sorting and Searching Algorithms

سارٹنگ (Sorting) کا مطلب ہے ڈیٹا کو صعودی (چھوٹے سے بڑے) یا نزولی (بڑے سے چھوٹے) ترتیب میں رکھنا۔

CS XI

Chapter 2: Computational Thinking & Algorithm

Lecture 07 of 13

2.4 Sorting and Searching Algorithms

LEARN IT

Sorting and searching are both fundamental techniques of computer science. They work on **lists of the same data type** (for example, a list of all integers or a list of all names).

Sorting	Searching
Arranging a collection of items in an order. The order may be ascending (0–9, A–Z) or descending (9–0, Z–A). Used to organise data.	Locating a specific element within a list to find its position or check its existence (is it there or not?).
Examples: Bubble Sort, Selection Sort	Examples: Linear Search, Binary Search
Real life: merit list arranged from highest to lowest marks.	Real life: finding your roll number in the merit list.

Notation you will see

- **DATA** — the list (array). `DATA[1]` is the 1st element in the textbook algorithms (counting starts at 1).
- In **pseudocode and Python** counting starts at **0**: `DATA[0]` is the 1st element. This is called an **index**.
- **N** — the number of elements in the list.
- **PTR** (pointer) — a variable that holds the current position.
- **temp** — a temporary variable used to **swap** (exchange) two values.
- **Pass** — one complete run of the inner loop over the list.

WORKED EXAMPLE

How a swap works with temp. Suppose $A = 8$ and $B = 4$. To exchange them:

`temp = A (temp = 8)` → `A = B (A = 4)` → `B = temp (B = 8)`

Without `temp`, writing `A = B` first would destroy the 8. In Python you may also write `a, b = b, a`.

COMMON MISTAKE

Position 1 in the textbook algorithm is index 0 in Python. In exams, if a question uses `DATA[1]`, count from 1; if it uses Python, count from 0. State clearly which one you use.

اردو میں سمجھیں

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CHECK YOURSELF

1. Arrange C, A, D, B in descending order.
2. What is the purpose of the variable `temp`?

Answers: 1. D, C, B, A. 2. It temporarily holds one value so that two values can be swapped without losing either.

Next lecture: 2.4.1 Sorting Algorithms: Bubble Sort